The Tenses Chart

	Past	Present	Future
Simple	Saran **wrote** a poem yesterday. Usage: to indicate a past habit or an action already completed	Saran **writes** a poem everyday. Usage: to express habits or general truth; to indicate a future event on a designated date as part of a plan or arrangement	Saran **will write** a poem tomorrow. (Helping verb) 'will' + present tense verb Usage: to indicate an action, condition, or circumstance that hasn't taken place yet
Progressive or Continuous	Saran **was writing** a poem when his friends arrived. was/were + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate uncompleted action of the past (with or without time reference); to indicate persistent habits of the past (with 'continuously', 'always', 'forever', etc.)	Saran **is writing** a poem right now. am/is/are + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate action occurring at the time of speaking; to indicate a temporary action that may not be occurring at the time of speaking	Saran **will be writing** a poem when his friends arrive. will be + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate what will be going on at some time in the future; to indicate planned future events
Perfect	Saran **had written** a poem when his friends arrived. had + past participle Usage: to indicate a completed action of the past that happened before another event took place	Saran **has written** the poem. have/has + past participle Usage: to indicate a past action which is not defined by a time of occurrence; to indicate an action that started in the past and has continued until now	Saran **will have writte**n a poem by the time his friends arrive. will have + past participle Usage: to indicate an action that will be complete before another event takes place
Perfect Continuous	Saran **had been writing** a poem for two hours when his friends arrived. had been + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate an action in the past that began before a certain point in the past and continued until that point of time	Saran **has been writing** a poem for two hours. have/has been + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate an action which started at some point in the past and may or may not be complete	Saran **will have been writing** a poem for four days. will have been + (-ing verb form) Usage: to indicate an action that will have happened for some time and will not be complete yet at a certain point in the future

01-A-Prose-The Portrait of a Lady-17-FEB.indd 13 11-01-2019 15:35:40